

Plants for wildlife gardens

Whatever your design style, bring your garden to life with a collection of berries, seeds, and nectar-rich plants to attract birds and beneficial insects.

A wildlife garden can be formal or informal, although the scope is limited in a tightly controlled design. You can create habitats for nesting birds with prickly hedging and trees to protect them from predators. Include shrubs that bear nuts and berries, such as hawthorn and viburnum, to feed your feathered friends over winter. Plants rich in pollen and nectar will attract beneficial insects, including butterflies and bees, as well as those whose larvae help control pest populations. A naturalistic pool surrounded by moisture-loving plants will also draw in birds and beasts to drink and bathe.



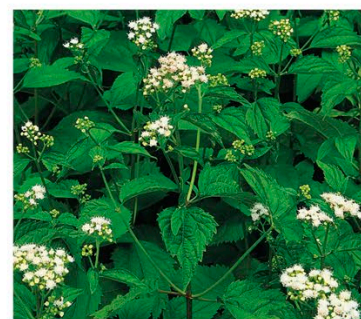
TREE LARGE

Acer rubrum

RED MAPLE This large tree has green leaves that turn yellow and orange in fall. The red spring flowers provide pollen for bees, and winged fruits are food for birds and squirrels. 'Bowhall' has a columnar habit.

↑70ft (20m) ↔30ft (10m)

☀ ☀ ☀ Z3-9 (N)



PERENNIAL LARGE

Ageratina altissima

WHITE SNAKEROOT This clump-forming perennial has pointed, oval, toothed-edged leaves. From summer to early fall, upright stems are topped with clusters of tiny white blooms that are a rich source of nectar for butterflies.

↑4ft (1.2m) ↔18in (45cm)

☀ ☀ ☀ Z4-8 (N)



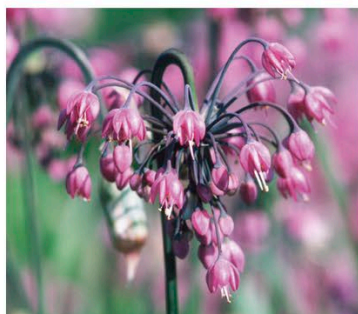
PERENNIAL LARGE

Alcea rosea

HOLLYHOCK A tall, short-lived perennial or biennial with rounded lobed leaves. From mid- to late summer, it bears purple, red, pink, white, or yellow cup-shaped blooms that attract butterflies and bees. Considered invasive in many areas; may self-seed.

↑6ft (2m) ↔24in (60cm)

☀ ☀ ☀ Z3-9



BULB LARGE

Allium cernuum

NODDING ONION This upright perennial bulb produces strap-shaped gray-green leaves that fade before clusters of nectar-rich, drooping purplish pink flowers appear on slim stems in early summer. Use it to naturalize in meadows.

↑28in (70cm)

☀ ☀ ☀ Z3-9 (N)



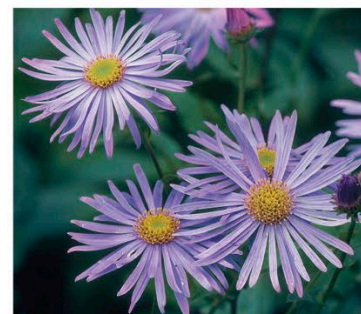
PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Asclepias tuberosa

BUTTERFLY WEED This tap-rooted perennial bears flat heads of vivid orange or yellow flowers from late summer to fall. Great nectar source for pollinators and host plant for monarch butterflies. The milky sap is an irritant.

↑30in (75cm) ↔18in (45cm)

☀ ☀ ☀ Z4-8 (N)



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Aster x frikartii

FRIKART'S ASTER An upright perennial with yellow-centered lavender-blue, daisy-like flowers that bloom over a long period from midsummer to fall, and provide nectar for butterflies. Plant in bold swaths in a flower border or naturalistic schemes.

↑28in (70cm) ↔16in (40cm)

☀ ☀ ☀ Z5-8



SHRUB LARGE

Berberis darwinii

DARWIN'S BARBERRY An evergreen shrub, with tiny hollylike leaves, that is smothered with pendent clusters of dark orange flowers in spring that attract bees. Birds devour the blue-black berries that follow. Use as a specimen plant or hedge.

↑↔10ft (3m)

☀ ☀ ☀ Z7-9



PERENNIAL SMALL

Bergenia silverlight

PIGSQUEAK This neat clump-forming evergreen perennial has leathery rounded leaves. In spring, reddish stems carry clusters of white bell-shaped flowers that open from deep red buds, making an attractive contrast.

↑18in (45cm) ↔20in (50cm)

☀ ☀ ☀ Z3-8



ANNUAL/BIENNIAL MEDIUM

Calendula officinalis

POT MARIGOLD The orange or yellow daisy-like flowers of this fast-growing bushy annual attract a wide range of insects. Choose single-flowered varieties for wildlife gardens, and sow seeds directly in flowerbeds or patio pots.

↑↔24in (60cm)

☀ ☀